

The Company to Beat

AutoRek is the closest thing in the world to what we are building. It sells reconciliation and financial control software to regulated financial firms: it ingests data from banks, custodians, payment schemes and policy systems, matches it, routes what will not match, posts the journals, signs the result off and keeps the evidence. **Thirty-two years old, £28.0M of revenue, growing 34 per cent a year, and holding about one and a half per cent of its own market.**

£28.0M

REVENUE, YEAR TO
31 JANUARY 2026

1.5%

SHARE OF THE
MARKET
THEY LEAD ON

100+

CLIENTS ACROSS 12
TO 15 COUNTRIES

1

REVIEW ON G2, IN
THIRTY-TWO YEARS

0

ANALYST RATINGS,
FROM ANY FIRM

1 How they won, which is the part worth learning

1 A rule, not a product

- They began in 1994 as a Glasgow consultancy doing custom data work. The product fell out of client engagements and first deployed in 1998.
- **Client asset rules turned reconciliation evidence into a non-discretionary purchase**, with a deadline and a named officer carrying personal liability. Their rules engine happened to fit.
- The founder has said 30 per cent of clients bought it for client money compliance.
- Every vertical, every geography and the artificial intelligence layer were built on top of a budget line a regulator created.

2 A machine, run patiently

- Two proprietary research reports a year, one per priority vertical, timed to the first quarter. Every statistic feeds a wire release, a webinar and a sales slide for twelve months.
- A page for every industry **and** a page for every reconciliation type.
- The outcome metric sits in the headline and in the web address, so every story is findable by its result.
- Procurement badges most firms skip: SOC 1 and 2 type 2, ISO 27001, the financial services supplier qualification scheme.

3 Then capital took over

- **Scottish Equity Partners** took 50 to 75 per cent in February 2021. The founder moved aside in October 2023 after twenty-six years.
- The whole executive bench has been replaced since. Only the finance chief predates 2023.
- In six weeks this summer: a share buyback, a new holding company, new articles and a **bank charge to Canadian Imperial Bank of Commerce**. Unannounced.
- Four days later they bought **Grath** for its multi-tenant software and its embedded matching interface.

They are a regional specialist that markets like a category leader.

The banking and insurance slice of reconciliation software runs to about 1.2 billion US dollars. AutoRek holds close to one and a half per cent of it. Their defensible ground is narrower still: United Kingdom regulated firms carrying a client money or safeguarding duty, where they are a credible top three. Read every claim they make against that scale.

2

Four doors they have left open

7,600	115	£280K	0	17 mo
WEBSITE VISITS A MONTH	SEARCH TERMS THEY RANK FOR	BLENDED REVENUE PER CLIENT	PRICES PUBLISHED IN THIRTY-TWO YEARS	SINCE THEIR FIRST UNITED STATES OFFICE

- 1

The shortlist

One review on G2 after thirty-two years and more than a hundred clients. No Chartis, Gartner, Forrester, Celent or Datos placement anywhere. About **7,600 website visits a month and 115 tracked search terms**, because their key pages render in the browser and return nothing but navigation to a crawler. A buyer who builds a shortlist the modern way, through review sites, analyst notes or an answer engine, will not find them.
- 2

The long tail

No published price, no trial, no self-serve, single-tenant architecture, and implementation measured in months against their own best claim of return on investment in nine. Blended revenue per client sits near **£280,000**. The new safeguarding regime is creating hundreds of small regulated firms with a hard daily duty and no budget for a platform at that price. They bought a second product to reach them rather than rebuilding the first.
- 3

North America

Their reference base is United Kingdom weighted. There is no United States rule forcing daily dual reconciliation the way the United Kingdom regime now does, so the pitch there rests on operating economics rather than a deadline. A competitor already publishes content telling buyers to **verify their United States implementation experience**. New York opened in March 2025, Miami in June 2026. The build is seventeen months old.
- 4

The architecture

Their strongest technical claim is that nothing can be deleted, only rolled back to a point in time. That is the right instinct and it is **a database policy enforced by the vendor**. Once the vendor holds the record, it proves nothing to a third party. Six products across two codebases after an August acquisition makes that harder to revisit, not easier.

Bars start at zero and share one scale. Counts are public review totals on G2. The gap is not a matter of degree. **A buyer comparing three vendors on a review site sees two of them.**

FloQast		1,393	4.6 average
BlackLine		1,050	4.5 average
AutoRek		1	one reviewer, February 2023

The opening is real, and it has a clock on it.

Every one of these four is fixable by them, and three of them are cheap. Fifty verified reviews and an analyst briefing would close the first inside two quarters. The Grath integration answers the second within a year or so. The United States build compounds on its own. **The fourth is the only one they cannot fix without rewriting what they have spent thirty-two years building.**

3 How we stay ahead

1 Take the ground they hold

- **Build on the rule, not the category.** A landing page for the rule number, not for the product. One of their top three search terms is a client asset rule reference.
- **Run the annual survey.** One per vertical, timed to the first quarter. It is the highest leverage thing they do and the cheapest to copy.
- **Metric in the headline.** In the title and in the address, so every story is findable by its outcome.
- **Scale instead of the logo.** Where a client will not go on the record, publish the number they are measured by.

2 Take the ground they left

- **Publish a price.** They never have, in thirty-two years, anywhere.
- **Commit to a timeline.** Weeks against their nine months, with something commercial behind the commitment.
- **Win the review sites and brief the analysts.** Both are open and both are cheap.
- **Serve the firms they cannot afford to serve.** The safeguarding long tail is arriving now and their economics do not reach it.

The one question that separates us from all of them.

AutoRek keeps a very good record of a reconciliation, and asks the regulator to trust the vendor that the record was never touched. So does everyone else in the category. **Who has to be trusted for this record to stand up?** Ask that in any room and the answer changes the shape of the evaluation.

Watch this monthly

Whether they publish a price or a trial. Whether review counts move past single figures. Whether an analyst placement appears. Whether the Grath platform is presented as a migration path or a permanent second product. Any one of those closes a door.

Watch this quarterly

United States customer announcements with named logos and hard numbers. That is the signal their reference base has stopped being a United Kingdom base, and it is the change that would matter most to us.

Do this next

Pull the FY2026 statutory accounts direct from Companies House. One document answers the audit status, the geographic revenue split, the subsidiary list and, most usefully, whether the July charge sits against acquisition financing or a shareholder distribution. A firm carrying fresh debt behaves differently from one carrying fresh equity.

What to hold on to.

A company built on a regulator's deadline reached £28M and a hundred clients without ever publishing a price, without an analyst rating, and with one public review. That is how much of this market is still decided in rooms rather than on shortlists, and it is how much room a better answer still has.